



andLinux

Run Linux in Windows... With a twist!

Rossi Fernandes

We keep complaining about how we'd like to use Linux but all our work and favourites applications are here on Windows. Virtualisation can be harnessed to run both Linux and Windows together, but virtual machines are very resource hungry and it's not practical. andLinux could be the solution to all your problems. With andLinux, you can run Linux applications on Windows without having to boot into Linux or run virtual machines. The andLinux installer can be found in this month's DVD. We're showing you a quick outline of some of its features.

Getting andLinux Up And Running

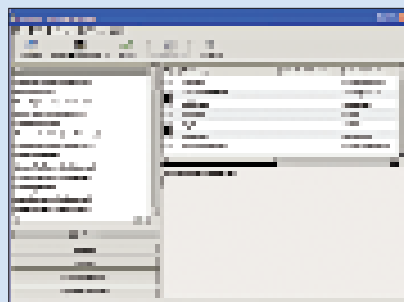
andLinux doesn't require you to create or modify any partitions, and the entire installation procedure is done on Windows like any other application. Double click the executable and continue beyond the agreement accepting window. Enter a suitable amount of memory that you want to allot to andLinux. If you want to use sound applications, check the radio box for enabling the audio support module. Similarly, if you want to use andLinux seamlessly when you boot into Windows, choose to set up andLinux as an NT service that runs automatically. Next, select the method you want to access the Windows file system. Choose CoFS, however, network shares can be used using Samba. The next step is to select the partition that can be accessed by andLinux. You can also set it to access a particular folder. Select the folder and proceed.

Accessing andLinux's Applications

If you're wondering where the andLinux applications are, they are all accessible from the icon in the system tray. If you want to run console applications, you can open a terminal session using Konsole or an andLinux terminal. The username to use is [root] with no password. The andLinux terminal allows you to jump to other terminals using the [Alt] + [F1] / [F2] / [F3] / [F5] / [F6] keys.

Adding New Software

You might think andLinux works like some kind of LiveCD that runs on

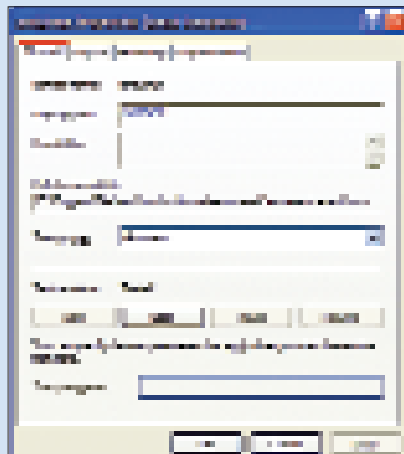


Synaptic Package Manager is an easy way to add applications to andLinux over the Net

Windows, but it is much more than that. LiveCDs generally don't let you install applications, which means you are stuck with what is provided. One of the most impressive features other than running Linux on Windows is that you can actually install new software on it. The simplest and quickest way to do this is to use the Synaptic Package Manager, as long as you have an Internet connection. Right-click on the system tray icon and click on Synaptic. Now search or browse through the directory for the software you want. Right-click on the application and click Mark for Installation. Click on Apply on the top menu to have the software downloaded and installed. You can also use apt-get to install, like you would in other distributions.

Stopping The Service

While it's fun to have andLinux and its applications running on Windows, it can sometimes be a resource hog especially if you don't have a lot of RAM to spare or if you're about to start some



andLinux can be temporarily shutdown by shutting down its service in Windows

intensive games. In such cases, you might want to shut down all the unnecessary services and programs running in the background. Go to the folder where you installed andLinux. Double click on `srvstop.bat` and the service will end. The service can also be shut through the Services manager under Windows Administrative Tools. To start the service again, double click `srvstart.bat`.

Using andLinux's Integration For Windows File Formats

If you haven't noticed, andLinux doesn't only run applications or open files in the Linux file system. You can browse through folders and use andLinux's applications run certain files—for example, .doc files can be opened using KWord. Browse using Windows explorer, right-click and you will see the application name in andLinux.

If you don't see an association made, you can open the application using the menu. Then proceed to open the file through the File > Open menu. Look for a path to Windows to open files in the Windows partition. You can also access the same partition through the path /mnt/win. Keep in mind, that andLinux will not be able to open paths outside the ones you specify during the installation.

Modifying The Launcher Menu

The andLinux launcher allows you to run most applications available in andLinux. It might even not add any new software that you download and install. The menu can be modified through a small text file located in the installation folder of andLinux—`andLinux\Launcher`. Open `menu.txt` in any text editor and add any new entries that you want. Adding—adds a separator in the menu. The format is—

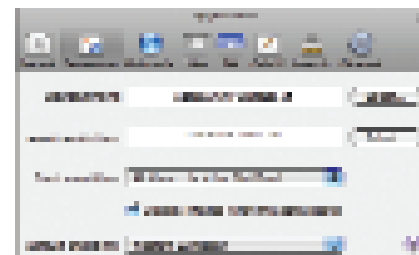
```
ApplicationName;ApplicationIcon.ico; ApplicationCommand.
For example, Digit;digit.ico;konqueror www.thinkdigit.com will add an entry Digit that will load www.thinkdigit.com in Konqueror. Unnecessary entries can be deleted from the list by removing a line. Save the files and close the launcher by right clicking on the system tray icon and then Exit. In the Launcher folder, run menu.exe again to restart the menu and you will now see the changes in place. ■
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rossi.fernandes@thinkdigit.com

Safari—a few months back is now finally out. We took a closer look at the latest version—3.1, which just arrived a couple of days ago.

Setting The Right Font Smoothing

Anyone who has used a Mac will tell you that the font smoothing and rendering on Apple Macs is really something.



Safari's font smoothing might not work great with CRTs as it does with LCDs

Safari tries to bring similar font smoothing to Windows. While some might find the fonts very pretty, some find it rather distracting. To change this setting, click on Edit > Preferences > Appearance. Use the Font smoothing drop-down and select Standard if you want the effect turned down to minimum. The default setting—Medium is generally preferred for LCD users.

Creating Temporary Bookmarks Using SnapBack

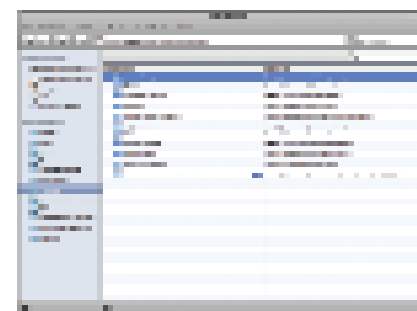
Safari has a feature called Snapback, which allows you to mark a temporary bookmark while you're browsing through a page. While on the page or site, click on History > Mark Page for SnapBack. Safari now remembers this page. Say you've proceeded several levels into the site and you want to return back to the main page on which you created the bookmark, click on History again and then on Page SnapBack.

Browsing Without Footprints

Safari has a feature called Private Browsing, which can be accessed by clicking on Edit > Private Browsing. This mode stops caching any of the pages that you visit from then on. No records such as history or passwords are maintained. This is useful for any user who might want complete privacy while checking their mail or while doing online transactions for example. To get back to the normal mode, go back to Edit > Private Browsing.

Bookmark Migration

If you like Safari, then you're bound to move your bookmarks to Safari at some point in time. Start your original browser and then export the bookmarks to an HTML file as that is what



Safari can easily import bookmarks from your other browsers through HTML files

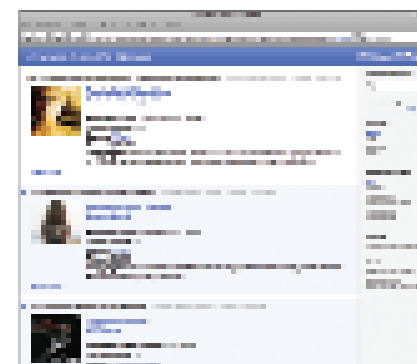
Safari uses to import bookmarks. Once that is done, click on File > Import Bookmarks. Select the file and click on the file you exported. A new windows view with all the imported bookmarks will now open. To have all the bookmarks accessible in the Bookmarks menu in Safari, select all the bookmarks and drag and drop them into the Bookmarks menu item in the left pane. Bookmarks can also be exported by clicking File > Export Bookmarks.

The other place where bookmarks can be displayed is the Bookmarks bar, which needs to be enabled by clicking on View > Show Bookmarks Bar.

RSS Feed Reader

Safari may be new to Windows, but Apple has still implemented some features such as feed reading into it. There is no separate feed reading window as we find in Opera to read feeds. When you visit a site with an RSS feed in it, click on the RSS icon in the address bar to read the feed right there. To save the feed, you need to add a bookmark as in any other page by clicking on Bookmarks > Add Bookmark. Controls for searching the feed, or changing the size of the preview or viewing feeds using a timeline are also present on the right pane.

To make changes to the refresh interval, click on Edit > Preferences > RSS and use the dropdown menu for Check for updates. There are also

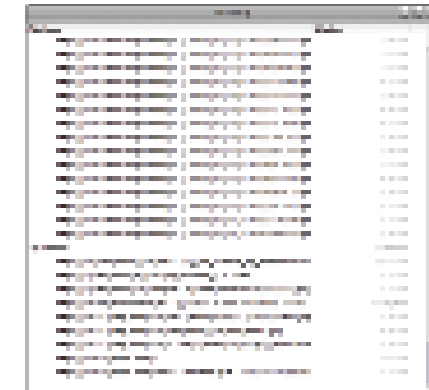


Safari has a simple feed reading feature but one with well integrated functionality

settings to automatically mark read items and highlight unread ones.

Monitoring Browser Activity

Most of the loading status bars used to indicate the percentage of



The activity tool allows the user to view the download status for all files in a page

objects in a page loaded, are usually inaccurate. Safari allows users to see the status of all the elements being downloaded in a separate window. Click on Window > Activity. You can see a neatly sorted list of files and their download status for all the sites open.

Spelling And Grammar Check

Safari's inbuilt spelling and grammar check can help avoid errors while writing mails or posting replies on a forum, for example. The checks can be enabled by clicking on Edit > Spelling and Grammar and click the menu items for spelling and grammar check. If you do make an error while typing, the mistakes will be highlighted by a red underline, which can be corrected by right-clicking on it and selecting the right spelling.

Reopening A Window From The Last Session

Unlike most browsers, where the last session can't be loaded unless you save it, Safari remembers the last session's sites and tabs. That means you can shut down Safari in a hurry without worrying about forgetting to bookmark those pages. To open the last session, click on Reopen All Windows from Last Session from the History menu. Other visited sites are also sorted according to dates in the same menu.

TOTAL COMMANDER ULTIMA PRIME

Total Commander has been well known as a replacement for Windows Explorer and has been around for many years. Total Commander Ultima Prime (TCUP), is, on the other